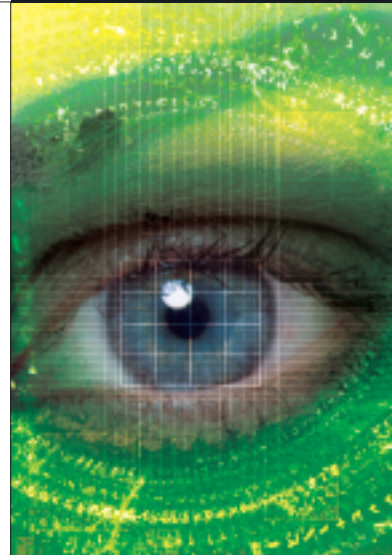


Jayesh Pancholi
CEO, Jet Pharma.

“We noticed that employees had unrestricted access to all areas of the company and we wanted to curtail this. We recently installed a protected access system, which not only provides access based on fingerprint analysis, but also does time tracking and payroll related work.

“With this system in place, we are now able to restrict employee access to only their workstations. Once you have the data for all the employees fed in, the system accurately records the time when an employee entered and left the office premises.

“We have noticed quite a few benefits since the system was installed, foremost amongst them being savings on stationary items. Apart from that, the ability to accurately track employee working hours and payroll is an added benefit.



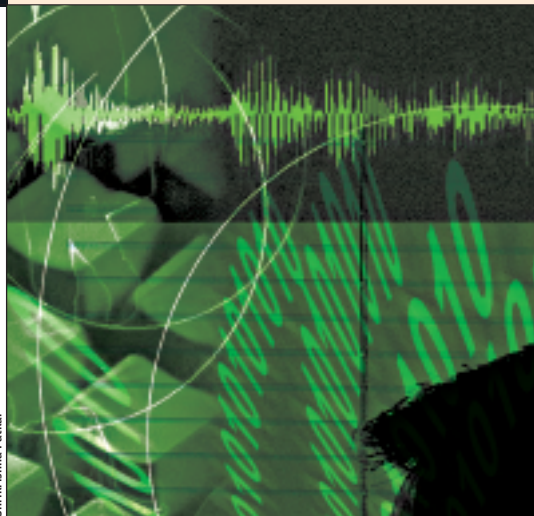
Manish Ved,
Manager,
Information Technology,
Bombay Hospital.

“Since installing this system, we have found reduced absenteeism amongst our Class IV employees, counter staff and technicians. We were also able to stop proxy punching of attendance cards. This has resulted in time saved, as we don’t have to physically verify the presence of our employees. Apart from this, the system is updated in real time so attendance records are always up to date with the most relevant information.

“We found that the two most important cost savings we made with this system were the man-hours saved and the reduced stationery expense since there are no punching cards or ledgers involved.”

BIOMETRICS FOR SECURITY

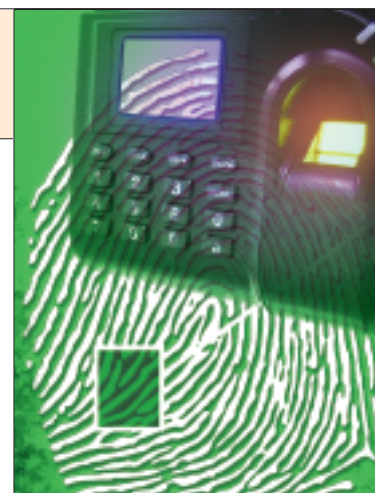
With a spate of companies employing Biometric tools to safeguard their businesses, we asked a few if it really made a difference.



Sachin Shah
CEO, Avadat Apparel Pvt. Ltd.

“We’ve installed a fingerprint access control system which also keeps employee time. This ensures that employee access to the office is compartmentalised while attendance records are kept up to date automatically.

“We have noticed that after installing this biometric system, we save approximately four man-hours every month on recording and maintaining the attendance records. Our efficiency is also improved since all data is available instantly. The fingerprint access control system ensures that bookkeeping is eliminated and access to important areas of factory such as the warehouse is restricted to only authorised personnel. The biometric scanners themselves are very efficient and work only when they detect a fingerprint pattern. This decreases battery and electrical consumption too.”



Bhavaniprasad Chaurasiya,
Deputy Manager-IT, Reliance Capital
Asset Management Limited.

“At our company, we have installed the ADF500 Biometric Reader, which allows us to secure the premises with various forms of security. Apart from being a fingerprint scanner, the device has a number pad, which allows you to assign numerical passwords. The system also works with RFID cards, which can be carried in-person to authorise access to any area of the company.

These systems have been more reliable in granting conditional access to employees than the earlier methods we adopted and personnel authorisation at entry and exit points is as good as personal verification. This system has helped us save cost on issuing new punch cards to all employees every month and reduced our expenses considerably. These biometric readers are installed in most of our offices, since they also provide up to date information on attendance and this helps us calculate payroll efficiently.”



Vinay C. Dhopavkar,
AGM-Human Resources,
Bombay Stock Exchange

“The Bombay Stock Exchange has installed the NAC2500 series of biometric fingerprint scanners for use in its premises. These installations are networked to a central server over LAN.

“Apart from securing our premises, these systems give us the ability to streamline the procedure of attendance, leave records, and allow us to retrieve this data immediately when required. We also rely on this system to generate various reports such as attendance, leave status and compensatory offs.

“Since its installation, we find that the system is able to provide very robust security measures apart from streamlining the attendance procedure. We have seen cost savings in terms of manpower, man-hours and stationery cost.”



Krishan Moorjani,
Asst. General Manager,
Datamatics Technologies Ltd.

“In the Business Process Outsourcing and Knowledge Process Outsourcing business, we have to use the latest technologies to help us save time, and the biometric scanners installed at all our facilities help us do so.

“The biometric installation at our premises is a multi-functional personal identification device that takes a three-dimensional scan of a person’s finger and compares it against a previously enrolled record. Security guards are immediately alerted to unmatched prints. The scanners are networked via our Intranet, and once a record is enrolled, it can be accessible across all our sites if needed. The biometric installation also allows for alternate methods of identification like entering a numerical password on the number pad or using an RFID-enabled security access card. The system allows us to create groups with different access levels, and users can be quickly added to those groups.

“Since the installation is networked via the intranet, employees can check their attendance stats themselves. Their attendance is automatically recorded in the main attendance database even if they log in from a different facility. The cost benefits with stationery expenses are hard to ignore too. Since its installation, we have found that there is a marked reduction in proxy punching and employee punctuality has increased.”

As told to Asfaq Tapia (asfaq_tapia@thinkdigit.com)